

Turning a Research Paper into a Poster

***This handout will walk you through the process of turning a research paper into a research poster. Refer to the “Example Research Project”, as it is used as the research paper for making this example poster.**

***The goal of making a poster is to present your information in a visually appealing and easy to understand format. Figures, tables, and main ideas are very important!!**

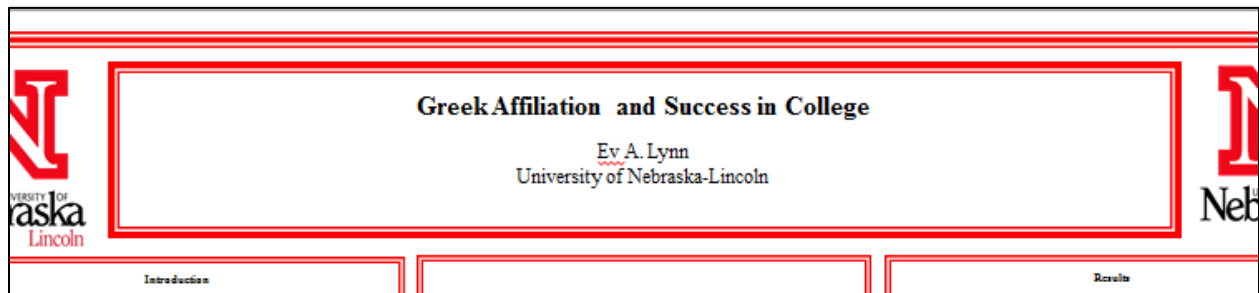
***Use the provided Poster Template as a start for your own poster. Feel free to resize sections if you need more room or if you have too much space.**

***Try to include as much blank space as possible. Large blocks of text are difficult to read quickly, and brevity is key!**

Step 1. Adding Author Information and Title

- Very long titles should be broken apart in an appropriate pause (like immediately after a colon) and included on to lines instead of one.
- The font should be around 24-28 point.

Poster:

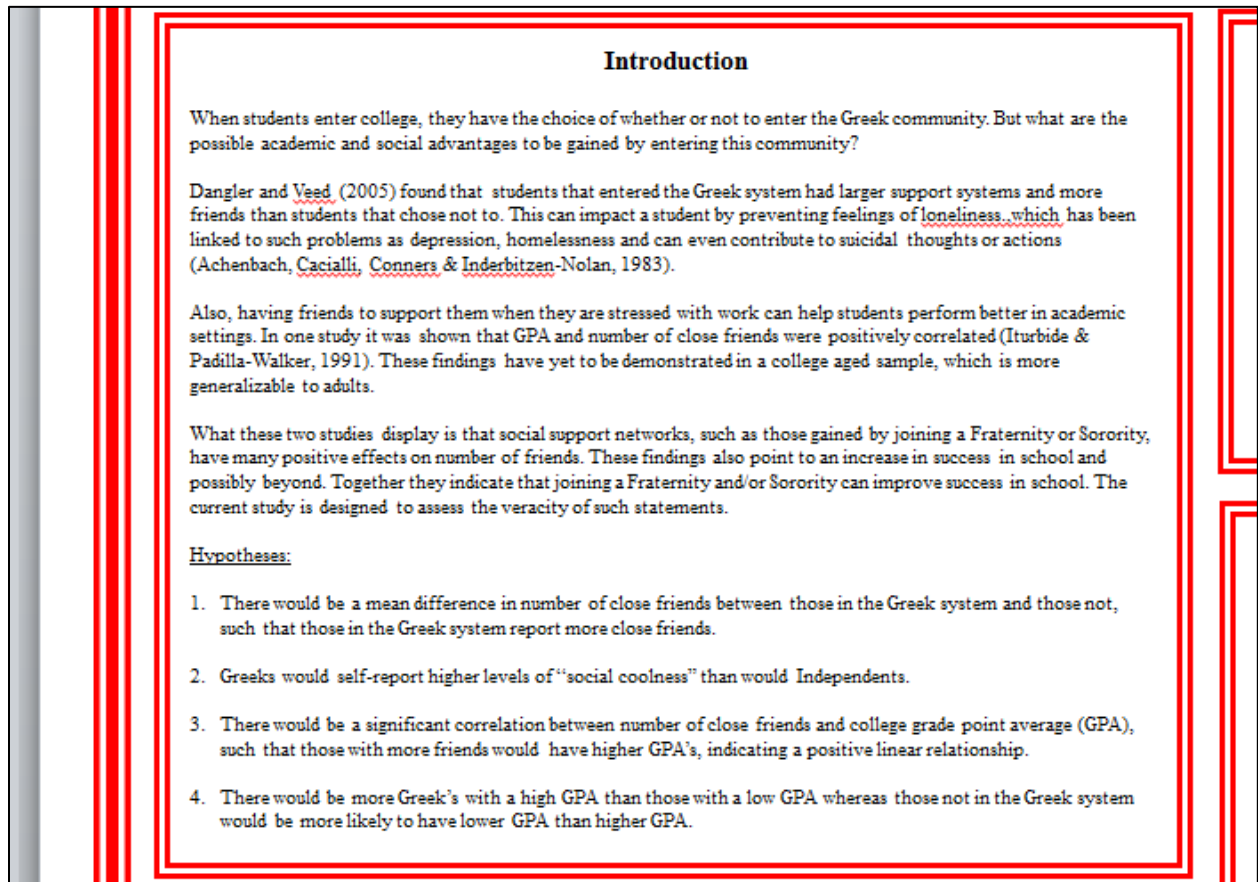


Step 2. Adding the Introduction

- Insert a text box and paste in your introduction (all 3 short summaries of your articles, the integration of the articles, and your hypotheses).
- Shorten the content (of the summaries and integration) slightly by pulling out your main ideas. Do not remove the citations!

- Separate your hypotheses from the rest of the introduction with the heading “Hypotheses”. All of them should be either numbered or bullet-pointed for simplicity.
- The font should be around 24-28 point.

Poster:



Step 3: Adding the Method Section

- Again you will keep most of the information, but shorten it into bullet points.
- For your materials:
 - 1 bullet can be used for any variables that are single-item questions (i.e., demographics questions).
 - You should have 1 bullet for each scale you used.
- The font should be around 24-28 point.

Poster:

Method
Participants • Sixty undergraduates from a large Mid-Eastern University participated in the current study, (43.3% male). • 76% were Caucasian, 17.6% African American and 5% Asian American with the remaining 1.4% being classified as Other. • They had a mean age of 21 years with a range from 20 to 24 years.
Materials • A self report survey that consisted of several questions including age, ethnicity, gender, if they are in a fraternity or sorority, current GPA, and number of close friends was created for this study. • Coolness Scale: 25-item scale asking students to identify how similar they are to prototypically cool social behaviors (-4 not like me at all to +4 totally like me) Higher scores indicate the student thinks they are more cool (Pitt, Jackson & Travolta, 2000).
Procedures • The survey was administered during the orientation meeting held at the beginning of the junior year etiquette class. • Each of the sixty students who attended that meeting provided complete data.

Step 4: Adding the Results Section:

- Again, paste your section into a text box.
- The first sentence, which is separate from the rest of the information, should refer to your table 1 of univariate statistics.
- Separate your paragraphs by what hypothesis you are addressing, and keep them in order of how you listed them in the introduction.
- Underline and/or bold the key findings for each hypothesis.
- The font should be around 24-28 point.

Poster:

Results

Univariate statistics for variables collected on the survey were shown in Table 1.

The first hypothesis stated that Greek students would report more close friends than Independent students. Contrary to the hypothesis, there was **no significant mean difference on number of close friends between Greek students and Independent students** $F(1,58) = 0.083, p = 0.775, Mse = 11.43$.

The related hypothesis that **Greeks would self-report higher levels of coolness** was supported, $F(1,58) = 9.23, p = 0.031, Mse = 7.65$. Table 2 summarizes the data for number of friends and social coolness for Greeks and Independents.

The third hypothesis stated that number of close friends would be positively correlated with GPA. Pearson's correlation between GPA and number of close friends was $r(58) = -0.215, p = 0.099$. There was **no linear relationship between number of close friends and GPA**. This result did not support the research hypothesis that students with a higher number of close friends would have higher GPA's.

The fourth hypothesis stated that more Greek students would have High GPA's than Low GPA's and Non Greek students would be more likely to have Low GPA's than High GPAs. GPA was divided into High and Low by recoding all students with GPA 3.0 or lower as having Low GPA's and those with above a 3.0 as having High GPA's.

Table 3 shows the resulting contingency table for these variables. More students had High GPA's than Low GPA's and more students were Greek than were not Greek. There was a relationship between GPA and Greek affiliation, $\chi^2(1) = 5.07, p = 0.024$. Inspection of Table 3 shows that, as hypothesized, **Greek students were more likely to have High GPA's than Low GPA's and Non Greeks were more likely to have Low GPA's than High GPA's**.

Step 5: Adding the Discussion Section:

- Paste your information into a text box and summarize accordingly. DO NOT INCLUDE THE PROPOSAL SECTION!!
- The font should be around 24-28 point

Poster:

Discussion

The results from these analyses were provided support for portions of the research hypotheses. The first and second hypotheses were not supported, showing no difference between number of close friends for Greeks and Non Greek and no positive correlation between number of close friends and GPA.

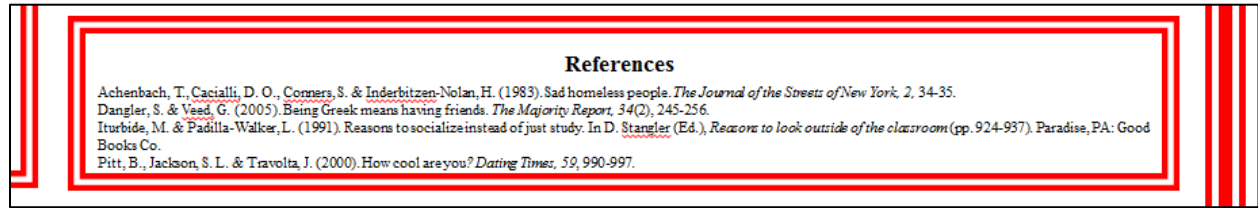
However, the last hypothesis was supported showing the Greeks were more likely to have High GPA's than Low and Independents were more likely to have Low GPA's than High GPA's. These findings were very interesting because they had contrary findings to Dangler and Veed (2005) and Iturbide and Padilla-Walker (1991). The related hypothesis that Greeks would report themselves as more cool was supported.

It was found that Greeks were more likely to have High than Low GPA's and Independents were more likely to have Low than High GPA's. This finding was very interesting because it indirectly supports the previous research by substituting GPA, which was found to be positively correlated with number of close friends, for social support and comparing it for Greeks versus Independents.

These results are very helpful when considering entering the Greek system. Results of whether or not joining a house can help you to be successful in college are inconclusive. It appears that just because someone is a member of a House, does not mean that they consider their fellow Greek members to be close friends. It also shows that having close friends might not be enough or even the most effective form of social support in order to boost success in college. In this population, there was no difference in number of friends for both groups. Family members and significant others might be more influential than friends when considering success.

Step 6: Adding your References:

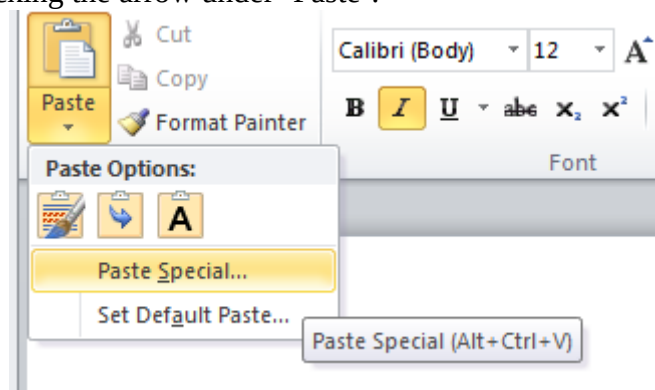
- Paste your references directly into a text box. Hanging indents are not necessary.
- The references do not need to be the same font size as the rest; 12-16 point font is adequate.



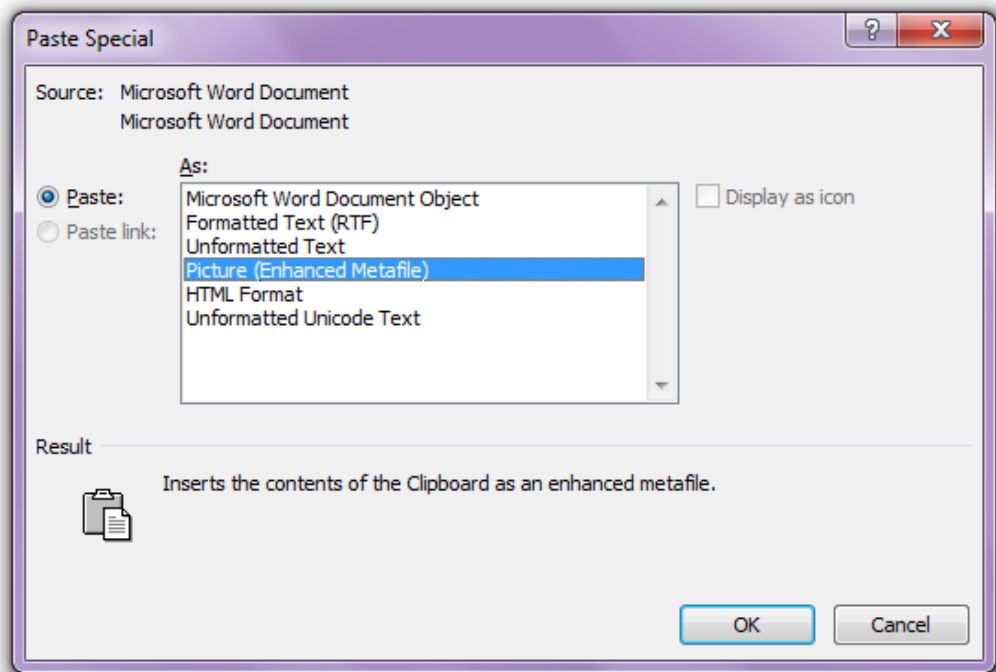
Step 7: Adding Tables and Figures:

- The easiest way to add figures to a poster made in a PowerPoint (like our template) is to first make them into images.
- Saving a table as an image (in Microsoft Word) in 6 easy steps:

1. Make the table using the insert table options in Word.
2. Highlight the entire table by clicking this icon in the top left corner:
3. Copy the entire table using either the copy option in Word or Ctrl + C on the keyboard.
4. Open a new document and, in the 'Home' tab, select 'Paste Special' by clicking the arrow under 'Paste'.



5. Select 'Picture (Enhanced Metafile)' in the pop-up window and hit OK.
 - Note: The option could also say 'Picture (Windows Metafile)'. Both of these options will give you the result you want.



6. Tada! Your table is now an image that can easily be copied and pasted into your poster, as well as resized to fit the poster.
- Figures made in either SPSS or Excel can usually be directly copied into PowerPoint without major formatting complications.
 - Table 1 should always be the first table listed on the poster. Other tables and figures should follow in the order to which they are referred in your text.



Greek Affiliation and Success in College

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Introduction

When students enter college, they have the choice of whether or not to enter the Greek community. But what are the possible academic and social advantages to be gained by entering this community?

Daugler and Wood (2005) found that students that entered the Greek system had larger support systems and more friends than students that chose not to. This can impact a student by preventing feelings of loneliness, which has been linked to such problems as depression, homesickness and can even contribute to suicide thoughts of college students (Achenbach, Caspi, Moffitt, & Silva, 1992).

Also, having friends to support them when they are stressed with work can help students perform better in academic settings. In one study it was shown that GPA and number of close friends were positively correlated (Pattillo-McKie, 1991). These findings have yet to be demonstrated in a college aged sample, which is more generalizable to adults.

What these two studies display is that social support networks, such as those gained by joining a Fraternity or Sorority, have many positive effects on number of friends. These findings also point to an increase in success in school and possibly beyond. Together they indicate that joining a Fraternity and/or Sorority can improve success in school. This current study is designed to assess the veracity of such statements.

Hypotheses

- There would be a mean difference in number of close friends between those in the Greek system and those not, such that those in the Greek system report more close friends.
- Greeks would self-report higher levels of "social coolness" than would Independents.
- There would be a significant correlation between number of close friends and college grade point average (GPA), such that those with more friends would have higher GPAs, indicating a positive linear relationship.
- There would be more Greeks with high GPA than those with a low GPA, whereas those not in the Greek system would be more likely to have lower GPA than higher GPA.

Method

Participants

- Thirty undergraduate from a large Mid-Western University participated in the current study. (61.3% male).
- 70% were Caucasian, 17.6% African American and 12.4% Asian American with the remaining 1.0% being classified as Other.
- They had a mean age of 21 years with a range from 20 to 24 years.

Materials

- A self-report survey that consisted of several questions including age, ethnicity, gender, if they are in a fraternity or sorority, current GPA, and number of close friends was created for this study.
- Coolness Scale: 15-item scale asking students to identify how similar they are to stereotypically cool social behaviors (-4 = not like me at all to +4 = really like me). Higher scores indicate the student thinks they are more cool (Pat Jackson & Travolta, 2000).

Procedures

- The survey was administered during the orientation meeting held at the beginning of the junior year college class.
- Each of the thirty students who attended that meeting provided complete data.

Table 1.
Summary of Greek Affiliation, GPA, and Number of Close Friends

Variable	Univariate Statistic		
Greek Affiliation	Greek	34 (56.7%)	
	Independent	26 (43.3%)	
GPA grouped	High GPA	27 (45%)	
	Low GPA	33 (55%)	
GPA	$M = 3.01$	$SD = 1.07$	$N = 60$
Number of Close Friends	$M = 5.93$	$SD = 3.35$	$N = 60$

Table 2.
Means (and standard deviation) Number of Close Friends and Coolness Self-Reports for Greek (n=34) and Independent (n=26) Students

Affiliation	Independents	Greeks
Number of Close Friends	6.08 (3.21)	5.82 (3.50)
Coolness Self-Reports	-1.82 (1.34)	2.87 (1.28)

Table 3.
Summary of High and Low GPA's for Greeks and Independents

Greek Affiliation	GPA		
	Low	High	Total
Independent	16	10	26
Greek	11	23	34
Total	27	33	60

Results

Univariate statistics for variables collected on the survey were shown in Table 1.

The first hypothesis stated that Greek students would report more close friends than Independent students. Contrary to the hypothesis, there was no significant mean difference in number of close friends between Greek students and Independent students $F(1,58) = 0.001, p = 0.975, \eta^2 = 0.001$.

The related hypothesis that Greeks would self-report higher levels of coolness was supported, $F(1,58) = 9.21, p = 0.001, \eta^2 = 0.14$. Table 2 summarizes the data for number of friends and social coolness for Greeks and Independents.

The third hypothesis stated that number of close friends would be positively correlated with GPA. Pearson's correlation between GPA and number of close friends was $r(58) = -0.215, p = 0.099$. There was no linear relationship between number of close friends and GPA. This result did not support the research hypothesis that students with a higher number of close friends would have higher GPAs.

The fourth hypothesis stated that more Greek students would have High GPAs than Low GPAs and Non Greek students would be more likely to have Low GPAs than High GPAs. GPA was divided into High and Low by recoding all students with GPA 2.0 or lower as having Low GPAs and those with above a 2.0 as having High GPAs.

Table 3 shows the resulting contingency table for these variables. More students had High GPAs than Low GPAs and more students were Greek than were not Greek. There was a relationship between GPA and Greek affiliation, $\chi^2(1) = 5.07, p = 0.026$. Inspection of Table 3 shows that as hypothesized, Greek students were more likely to have High GPAs than Low GPAs and Non Greeks were more likely to have Low GPAs than High GPAs.

Discussion

The results from these analyses were provided support for portions of the research hypotheses. The first and second hypotheses were not supported, showing no difference between number of close friends for Greeks and Non Greeks and no positive correlation between number of close friends and GPA.

However, the last hypothesis was supported showing the Greeks were more likely to have High GPAs than Low GPAs and Independents were more likely to have Low GPAs than High GPAs. These findings were very interesting because they had contrary findings to Daugler and Wood (2005) and Pattillo-McKie (1991). The related hypothesis that Greeks would report themselves as more cool was supported.

It was found that Greeks were more likely to have High than Low GPAs and Independents were more likely to have Low than High GPAs. This finding was very interesting because it indirectly supports the previous research by substantiating GPA, which was found to be positively correlated with number of close friends, for social support and comparing it for Greeks versus Independents.

These results are very helpful when considering entering the Greek system. Results of whether or not joining a house can help you to be successful in college are inconclusive. It appears that just because someone is a member of a House does not mean that they consider their fellow Greek members to be close friends. It also shows that having close friends might not be enough or even the most effective form of social support in order to boost success in college. In this population, there was no difference in number of friends for both groups. Family members and significant others might be more influential than friends when considering success.

References

- Achenbach, T. (2000). D. O. Caspi, E. Moffitt, & Silva, R. (1992). Self-reported loneliness. *Journal of the American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry*, 31, 1045.
- Daugler, E. A. & Wood, M. (2005). *College students' perceptions of the Greek system*. Lincoln, NE: University of Nebraska-Lincoln.
- Jackson, P. A. & Travolta, L. (2000). *College students' perceptions of the Greek system*. Lincoln, NE: University of Nebraska-Lincoln.
- Pat, A. & Travolta, L. (2000). *College students' perceptions of the Greek system*. Lincoln, NE: University of Nebraska-Lincoln.